ERGOTOOLS USER GUIDE

Keep ErgoTools up to date

A visual guide for Windows and macOS users



Download the code once. Update it with GitHub Desktop. Launch from the same desktop shortcut. Report problems with useful screenshots.

Before you start - create a GitHub account
For this guide, you need a free GitHub account. Create it at github.com/signup, verify your email, and use it to sign in to GitHub Desktop and report bugs. You do not need to write code or create branches.

This guide helps you	Where
Install and make a lasting launch shortcut	Windows: pages 7-9 macOS: pages 10-12
Get updates and identify your installed revision	Pages 13-16
Report problems and collect diagnostic evidence	Pages 17-24

Platform test edition | 5 November 2026
Repository: mhenriquezschott/ErgoTools

START HERE

Choose your route

Read the shared setup first, then follow only your operating system.

Read this section	Pages
Understand the folders and prepare GitHub Desktop	3-4
Find and clone the correct repository	5-6
Windows setup and desktop shortcut	7-9
macOS setup and desktop alias	10-12
Update the code and refresh libraries when needed	13-14
Record the installed revision and handle update problems	15-16
Open and write a useful bug report	17-19
Take screenshots and attach them safely	20-22
Launch problems, display reports, quick reference and sources	23-26

Platform setup is a trial recipe
ErgoTools setup and launch steps follow the current repository instructions. Native Windows/macOS installation, 3D rendering and solvers still need hands-on verification. If a step fails, keep the error text and ask the ErgoTools team rather than changing package versions.

System requirements for this guide: Windows 10/11 64-bit, or macOS 12+ for GitHub Desktop. Prefer Windows 11. The ErgoTools macOS trial itself lists macOS 11+, but GitHub Desktop requires 12+. Older Macs need a separately supported update route.

How to read the pictures: GitHub website captures show the real ErgoTools repository. Desktop and OS reference screenshots identify their source and may show sample names or an older appearance. Follow the written ErgoTools filenames and paths.

Reference: GitHub Desktop supported systems

01 / THE BASICS

Three tools and two folders

GitHub is where the code lives online. GitHub Desktop updates the copy on your computer. ErgoTools is the application you run.

Word	Meaning for you
Repository	The application code and supporting files.
Clone	Download a connected working copy once.
main	The branch to use for this guide. Other branches are not the current user route.
Fetch	Check GitHub for incoming changes.
Pull	Apply incoming changes to your local code.
Commit ID	A revision identifier that helps the team reproduce a problem.

Keep code separate from your work

Use one stable code folder in your home folder. Keep your personal .ergprj files in a different folder. Updates replace code and tracked examples; your research data should not live among them.

```
Home folder
  ErgoTools-code/
    ErgoTools/          application code
  ErgoTools projects/  your personal .ergprj files
```

A shortcut is a pointer
Your desktop shortcut or alias points to a launcher inside the code folder. Pulling updates in that same folder keeps the link useful. It does not update the code automatically.

02 / PREPARATION

Install GitHub Desktop

Create and verify your free GitHub account first, then use the official Desktop download.

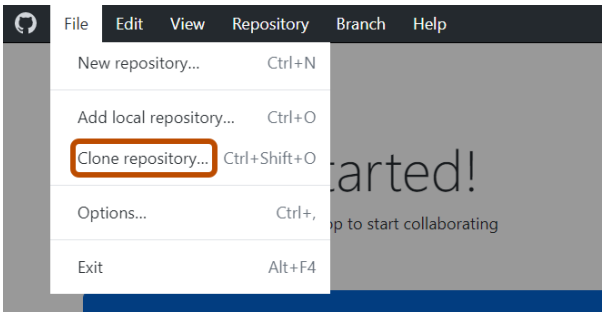
1 **Download the correct application**
Open desktop.github.com. Choose Windows or macOS. On a Mac, choose Apple silicon or Intel to match About This Mac.

2 **Install and open it**
Windows: open the downloaded setup file. macOS: open the downloaded archive, then open GitHub Desktop; keep the app in Applications if prompted.

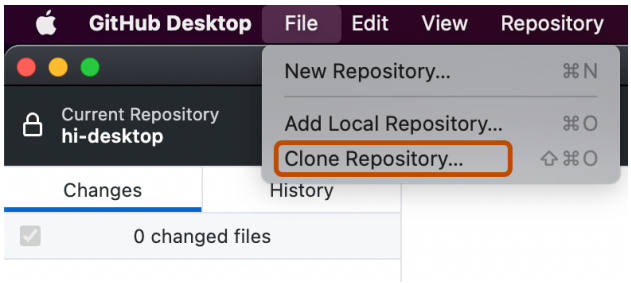
3 **Sign in through your browser**
No account yet? Open github.com/signup and verify your email first. In Desktop, choose Sign in to GitHub.com. Use your own account and complete its normal verification. Return to GitHub Desktop when the browser offers to open it.

4 **Finish the welcome screens**
Your Git identity is requested for contributions. You will only download updates in this guide; you do not need to make commits or fork ErgoTools.

The same action looks slightly different



Windows File menu. GitHub Docs reference screenshot.



macOS File menu. GitHub Docs reference screenshot.

If you already have GitHub Desktop, use the existing installation. The next step is **File > Clone Repository**, not Create a New Repository.

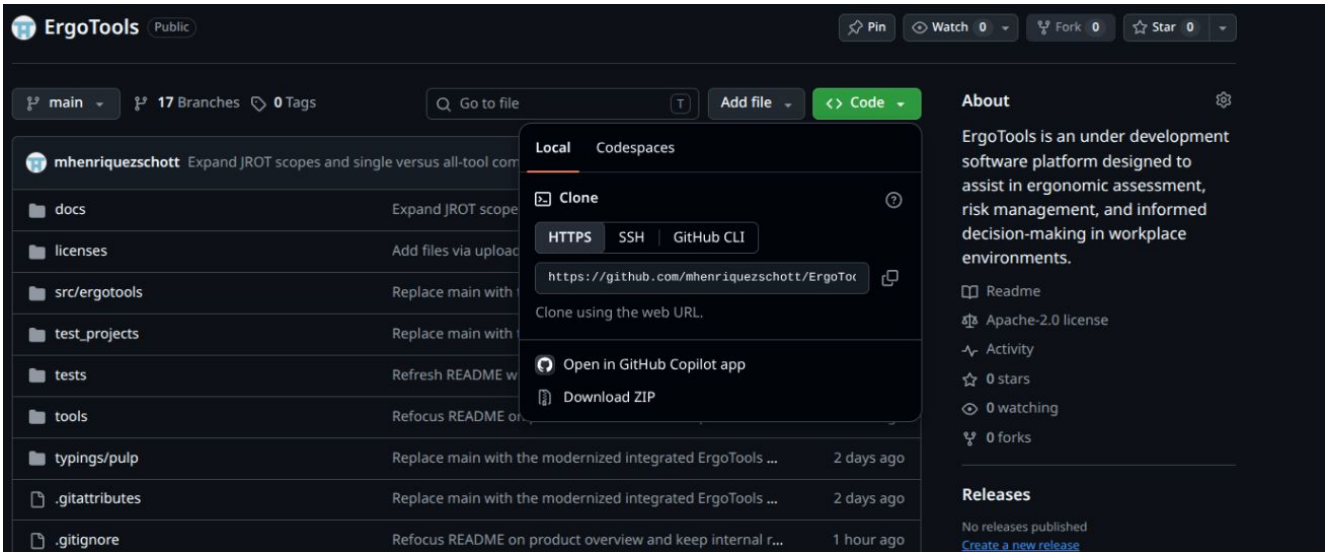
Reference: Installing GitHub Desktop

03 / GET THE CODE

Find the right repository

Open the official ErgoTools page in your web browser.

```
https://github.com/mhenriquezschott/ErgoTools
```



Real ErgoTools repository, with Code > HTTPS open. Some owner-only controls in this capture will not appear for other users.

1 **Check the project and branch**
Confirm mhenriquezschott/ErgoTools and **main**. Do not select a backup branch or an older UI branch.

2 **Use the HTTPS repository address**
The Code menu exposes the address. You can copy the complete address below directly into GitHub Desktop.

```
https://github.com/mhenriquezschott/ErgoTools.git
```

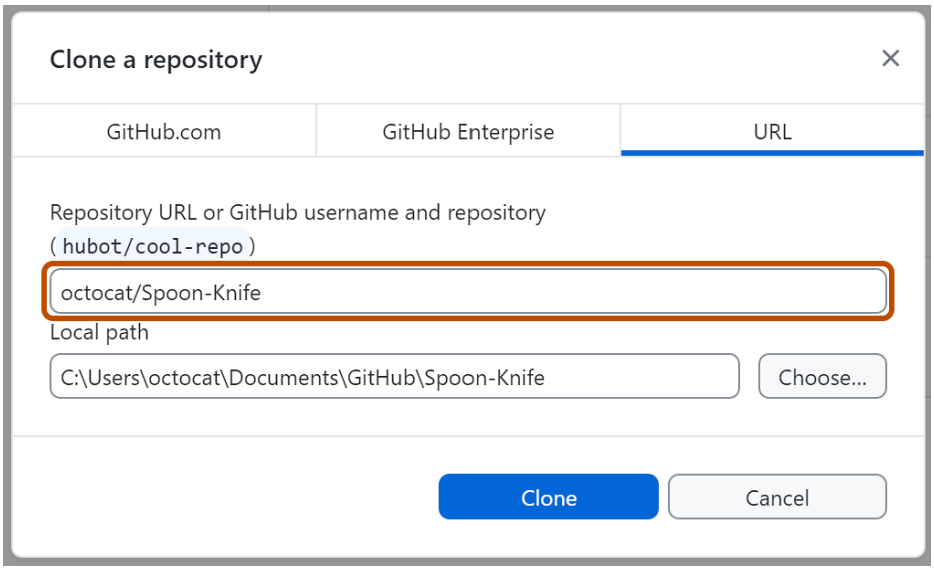
Use a clone, not repeated ZIP downloads
A downloaded ZIP is a snapshot, not an updateable Git working copy. The following page creates the connected copy you will update later. No SSH key is needed for the HTTPS route.

Reference: Repository and installation instructions

04 / GET THE CODE

Clone once with GitHub Desktop

Cloning creates your local ErgoTools folder. It does not yet install Python or the application libraries.



GitHub Docs reference screenshot. Its sample repository is not ErgoTools: replace that field with the ErgoTools HTTPS address on page 5.

1 **Choose File > Clone Repository, then URL**
Paste https://github.com/mhenriquezschott/ErgoTools.git into the repository field.

2 **Choose a stable local path**
Create **ErgoTools-code** inside your home folder. Set the final Local Path to **ErgoTools-code/ErgoTools**, ending with ErgoTools. Prefer a local, non-synced folder.

3 **Click Clone and let it finish**
Select ErgoTools as Current Repository and main as Current Branch. If a different branch is active, select main while there are no local changes.

Find your home folder: Windows: open File Explorer, enter **%USERPROFILE%** in its address bar and press Enter. Mac: open Finder and choose **Go > Home**. Create the ErgoTools-code folder there.

Already have a clone?
Use File > Add Local Repository and choose its existing folder. Do not clone on top of it. If you used a different location, substitute that location for the cd command on the setup pages.

Reference: Cloning a repository with Desktop

WINDOWS / FIRST SETUP

Prepare Windows for ErgoTools

Use Windows PowerShell for these initial commands. GitHub Desktop will handle routine code updates.

1 **Open PowerShell normally**
Open Start, type **Windows PowerShell**, and open it. You do not need Run as administrator for this user-folder setup.

A command is a line you paste into that window and run by pressing Enter. Do not type a leading $ or > prompt. Run one box at a time and wait until the prompt comes back.

2 **Install the pinned uv setup tool**
The command below downloads the official Astral installer. It installs uv for your user account; it is not an ErgoTools update command.

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy ByPass -c "irm https://astral.sh/uv/0.11.25/install.ps1 | iex"
```

3 **Close and reopen PowerShell**
This lets the new program location become available. In the new PowerShell window, check:

```
uv --version
```

What success looks like
The command prints a uv version instead of “not recognized”. The guide uses uv 0.11.25. If installation is blocked on a managed computer, ask IT; do not bypass your organization's policies.

Keep the GitHub Desktop clone in its chosen location. Do not create another clone or download a second ZIP while preparing Python.

Reference: Astral uv installation

WINDOWS / FIRST SETUP

Install the Windows environment

These commands apply to the clone path chosen on page 6.

1 **Enter your repository folder**
PowerShell uses $HOME for your actual user folder, so you do not need to type your Windows account name.

```
cd "$HOME\ErgoTools-code\ErgoTools"
```

If your clone is elsewhere, copy its full folder path from File Explorer and use **cd**, a space, and that path in double quotes instead. The folder must contain README.md and tools.

2 **Install the required Python**
Wait for the Python download to finish.

```
uv python install 3.13.14
```

3 **Create the application environment**
This prepares the application itself. The Windows graphical libraries are installed in the next command.

```
uv sync --locked --no-dev --python 3.13.14
```

```
uv pip install --python .venv\Scripts\python.exe --only-binary :all: -r tools\requirements_desktop_trial.txt
```

4 **Start ErgoTools**
Use the same PowerShell window.

```
.\tools\run_windows.cmd
```

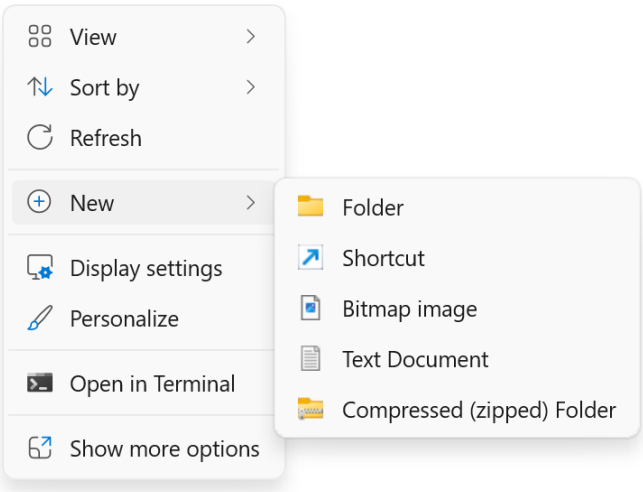
Check before continuing
Confirm that the main window opens and the avatar is visible. If a command reports an error, stop there and preserve the complete message. Windows uses Qt 5.15.2 because Qt 5.15.17 has no Windows wheel.

Reference: Current Windows trial recipe

WINDOWS / DAILY LAUNCH

Create the desktop shortcut

Make a link to the launcher inside the clone. Keep the original launcher there.



Microsoft reference screenshot: desktop right-click > New > Shortcut. Menus may differ slightly between Windows releases.

1 **Find the launcher first**
GitHub Desktop: choose **Repository > Show in Explorer**. Open the **tools** folder and locate **run_windows.cmd**.

2 **Create a desktop shortcut**
Right-click an empty part of the Desktop and choose **New > Shortcut**. Use Browse to select that run_windows.cmd file. Choose Next, name it ErgoTools, then Finish.

3 **Test the shortcut**
Close ErgoTools, then double-click the new link. It should open the same application from the same clone.

After future updates
Use that same shortcut after pulling changes. Do not copy run_windows.cmd onto the Desktop: a detached script looks for Python in the wrong place. If you move the code folder, recreate its environment and shortcut.

Alternative: right-click the launcher in File Explorer, then **Show more options > Send to > Desktop (create shortcut)**.

Reference: Windows desktop shortcuts

MACOS / FIRST SETUP

Prepare your Mac for ErgoTools

Use the Terminal application for the one-time setup. Use GitHub Desktop for ordinary code updates.

1 **Confirm the Mac architecture**
Apple menu > About This Mac identifies an Apple chip or an Intel processor. Use the matching GitHub Desktop and Python environment throughout.

2 **Open Terminal**
Press **Command + Space**, type **Terminal**, and press Return. A command runs when you paste it and press Return; wait for the prompt before continuing.

3 **Install the pinned uv setup tool**
Run this official Astral installer:

```
curl -LsSf https://astral.sh/uv/0.11.25/install.sh | sh
```

4 **Quit and reopen Terminal**
Then verify that uv is available:

```
uv --version
```

What success looks like
You see a uv version instead of “command not found”. This guide uses uv 0.11.25. If your Mac is managed by an organization and blocks installation, ask IT for help.

The prepared route requires macOS 12+ because of GitHub Desktop. On Apple silicon, use a native Terminal session rather than mixing Intel and arm64 tools. The next page installs the specified Python automatically.

Reference: Astral uv installation

MACOS / FIRST SETUP

Install the macOS environment

Use the clone path chosen on page 6, then run each command in order.

1 **Enter the repository folder**
The $HOME variable refers to your own user folder.

```
cd "$HOME/ErgoTools-code/ErgoTools"
```

If the clone is elsewhere, type **cd** and a space, drag the repository folder from Finder into Terminal, then press Return. Confirm that you selected the folder containing README.md and tools.

2 **Install Python and the application**
Run these two commands separately:

```
uv python install 3.13.14
```

```
uv sync --locked --no-dev --python 3.13.14
```

3 **Install the graphical and solver libraries**
The separate trial requirements are needed on macOS.

```
uv pip install --python .venv/bin/python --only-binary :all: -r tools/requirements_desktop_trial.txt
```

4 **Prepare and launch the script**
Run each line separately:

```
chmod +x tools/run_macos.command
```

```
./tools/run_macos.command
```

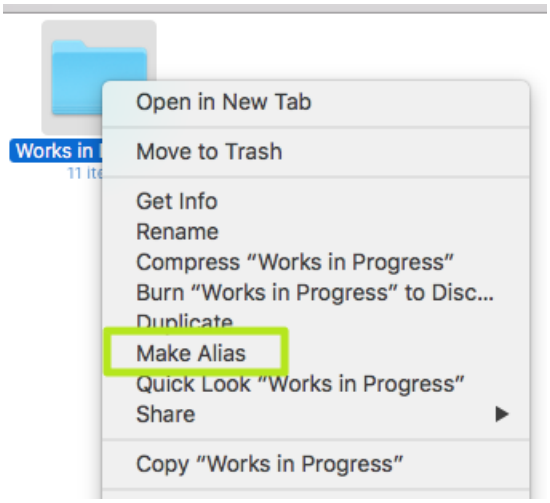
Check before continuing
Confirm that ErgoTools opens with its avatar visible. If startup fails, retain the Terminal message. The trial uses Qt 5.15.17 and the repository's specified versions.

Reference: Current macOS trial recipe

MACOS / DAILY LAUNCH

Create a desktop alias

An alias points to the original launcher; it is not another copy of the application.



Finder reference image from Schreiner University (2021). It illustrates Make Alias with a folder; for ErgoTools, select the launcher file named below.

1 **Open the repository in Finder**
In GitHub Desktop, choose **Repository > Show in Finder**. Open tools and select **run_macos.command**.

2 **Create the alias**
Choose **File > Make Alias**. Move the new alias to the Desktop and rename it ErgoTools. Leave the original .command file in tools.

3 **Test it**
Close ErgoTools, then double-click the alias. Terminal opens the launcher and the application starts.

If macOS blocks the launcher
Verify that this is the trusted repository launcher. Follow the normal per-item approval in Privacy & Security if appropriate; if the warning reports malware or organizational policy, stop and ask for help. Do not disable system-wide security.

Pulling updates into the same clone keeps the alias useful. Moving the entire installation requires environment and alias repair.

Reference: Apple aliases

Reference: Opening downloaded apps safely

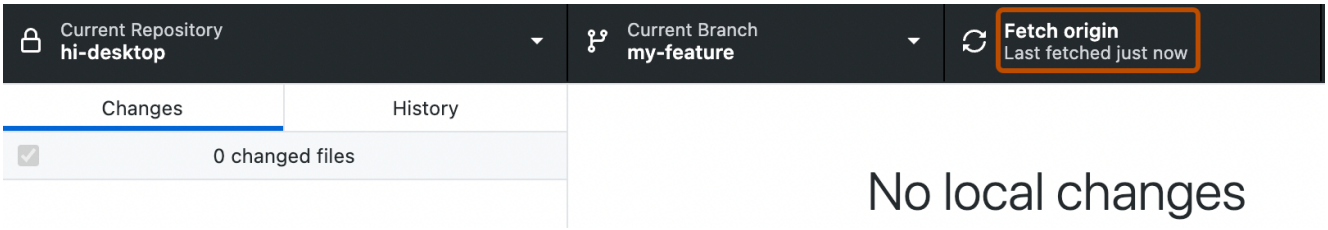
05 / ROUTINE UPDATES

Get the latest code

The same GitHub Desktop workflow applies on Windows and macOS.

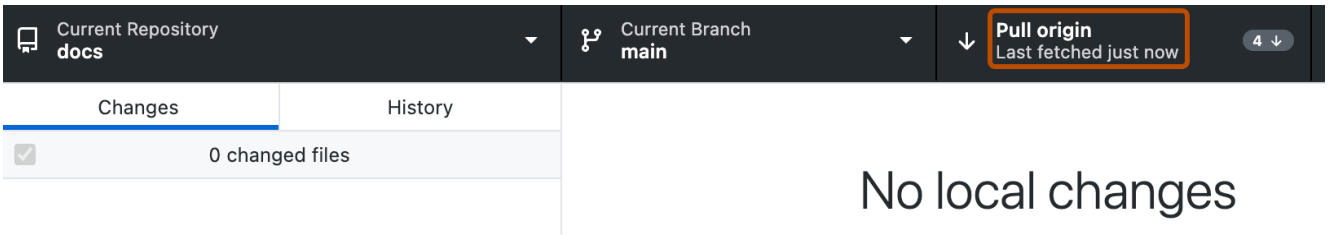
1 **Save your project and close ErgoTools**
Keep your .ergprj files outside the code folder. Do not update while an assessment or optimization is running.

2 **Confirm the repository and branch**
In GitHub Desktop, use **Current Repository: ErgoTools** and **Current Branch: main**. Check that Changes contains no unexpected edited files.



GitHub Docs reference image. Fetch origin checks for incoming commits; it is not the same as applying them.

3 **Fetch, then pull if offered**
Click **Fetch origin**. If **Pull origin** appears, click it and wait. If GitHub Desktop reports the branch is up to date, no pull is needed.



GitHub Docs reference image. Pull origin applies incoming changes to the local branch.

4 **Check the update instructions, then reopen**
If dependencies or launch instructions changed, follow page 14 before launching. Otherwise use your existing desktop shortcut or alias.

No push is needed
Pull receives the team's changes. Push publishes local commits; it is not part of this user update routine. An internet connection is required to check or download updates.

Reference: Syncing your branch in GitHub Desktop

06 / AFTER AN UPDATE

When libraries also need refreshing

Code updates and environment updates are separate. Follow the team's update notice when Python or requirements change.

If the update changes pyproject.toml, uv.lock, .python-version, tools/requirements_desktop_trial.txt or a launcher, read the current installation instructions. The commands below reflect this guide's pinned baseline, not a promise that future versions will keep it.

Windows PowerShell

```
cd "$HOME\ErgoTools-code\ErgoTools"
```

```
uv sync --locked --no-dev --python 3.13.14
```

```
uv pip install --python .venv\Scripts\python.exe --only-binary :all: -r tools\requirements_desktop_trial.txt
```

macOS Terminal

```
cd "$HOME/ErgoTools-code/ErgoTools"
```

```
uv sync --locked --no-dev --python 3.13.14
```

```
uv pip install --python .venv/bin/python --only-binary :all: -r tools/requirements_desktop_trial.txt
```

Run both environment commands
On these trial platforms, uv sync can remove separately installed desktop libraries. Complete the following uv pip install as well. A missing PyQt5, VTK or solver module after updating can indicate this unfinished step.

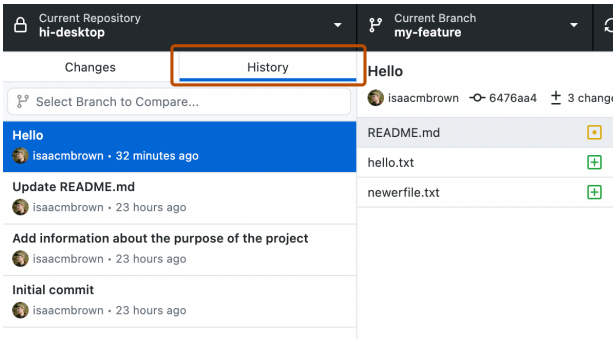
Current requirements include HiGHS and spreadsheet-import support; no solver-choice setting is needed. An ordinary code-only update normally keeps the existing environment. Follow a new Python requirement explicitly rather than substituting versions.

Reference: ErgoTools update and trial environment instructions

07 / IDENTIFY YOUR VERSION

Record the installed revision

A commit ID tells the team exactly which code your local clone contains.



GitHub Docs reference screenshot: the History tab lists downloaded commits. Its example is not the ErgoTools repository.

1 **Open your local clone history**
GitHub Desktop: select ErgoTools and main, then click **History**. Select the newest commit at the top.

2 **Copy the commit identifier**
Use **Copy SHA** from the commit's context menu, or copy the displayed identifier. Include the commit title and ID in your report. Copy the identifier, not the repository's latest web revision.

3 **Add your system details**
Windows: Settings > System > About. Mac: Apple menu > About This Mac. Record the OS version and system/chip type, excluding serial numbers or device identifiers.

Local and online versions can differ
The latest commit shown on GitHub is not proof that your local application has it. Check History in the same clone targeted by your desktop link.

Keep a short test record

Record	Example of the information to include
Code	main; full commit ID copied from Desktop
Computer	Windows 11 x64, or macOS version and Apple/Intel chip
Application context	LiFFT/DUET/ST, metric/imperial, language, window size
Project	Anonymized test copy; whether the issue repeats after reopening

Reference: Viewing branch history

08 / UPDATE PROBLEMS

If an update does not go smoothly

Preserve your work. A report of the exact message is more useful than repeated repair attempts.

What you see	What to do
Local changes or a conflict	Stop the pull. Note the listed files and capture the message. If they are your .ergprj files, copy them outside the repository and ask the team how to proceed.
Push origin, Publish branch or a fork prompt	You may have local commits or the wrong branch/repository. Do not publish them merely to update. Ask for help.
No changes after Fetch	Check main and confirm the repository owner/name. You may already be current. Reopen ErgoTools after a successful pull.
The repository is not found	Check the HTTPS address and internet connection. If access has changed, contact the team.
The shortcut opens an older copy	Use Show in Explorer/Finder to locate the updated clone. Check the link target; remove duplicate installations only after preserving projects.

Avoid destructive shortcuts
Do not use Discard All Changes, git reset --hard, git clean, or delete your installation as a first response. These can remove local work. A normal user update needs Fetch and Pull only.

Screenshots of the Changes list or error are helpful. Also record whether your files are stored in OneDrive, iCloud or another redirected/synced folder; this can explain path or permission differences.

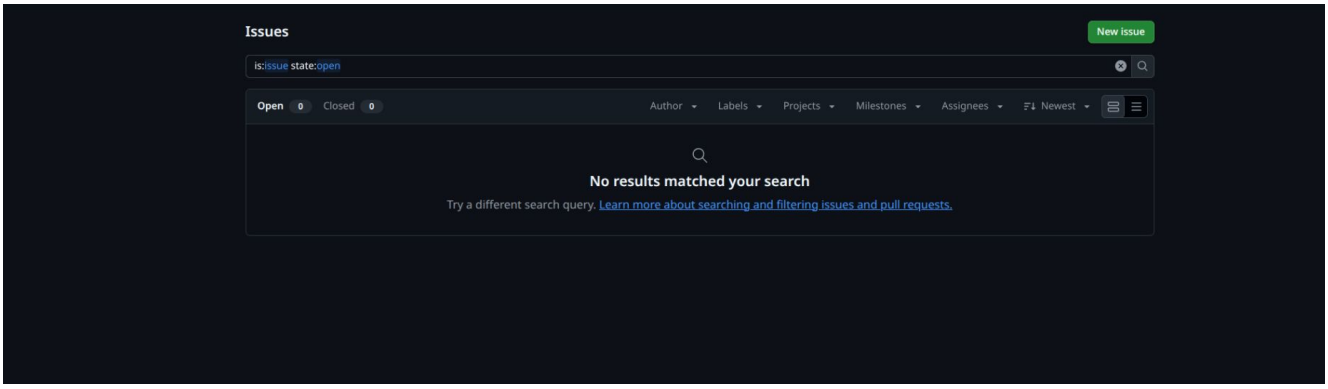
If the repository folder was moved, the old virtual environment may no longer be valid. Ask the team to recreate it using the current installation recipe, then rebuild the desktop link.

09 / REPORT A BUG

Search before creating a report

Use the Issues area of this repository, not a new code branch.

```
https://github.com/mhenriquezschott/ErgoTools/issues
```



Actual ErgoTools Issues page. It was empty at capture time; your list may already contain reports.

1 **Sign in and search for the symptom**
Use a few distinctive words such as PLOT, gauge or hiring date. Remove the open-only filter, or inspect Closed, to include resolved reports.

2 **If an existing report matches**
Read it and compare the code version and circumstances. Add a useful comment to the same report instead of opening a duplicate.

3 **If it is a different problem**
Choose **New issue**. If a template chooser appears, use the bug-report template; otherwise use the plain issue form shown next.

One problem per issue
Give each unrelated symptom its own report. A concise title should name the affected area and the observable problem, such as “PLOT label is clipped after resizing”.

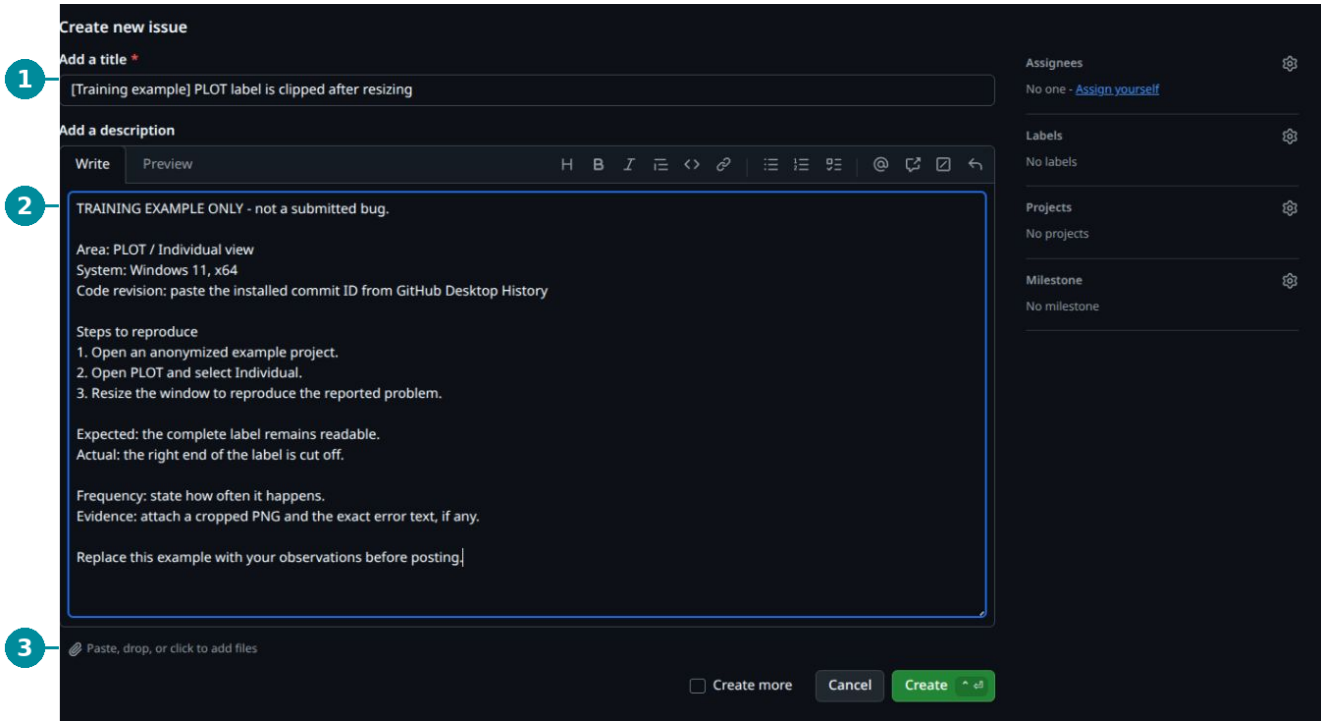
Reference: Creating an issue

Reference: Searching and filtering issues

10 / REPORT A BUG

Complete the issue form

The picture shows a training example in the real repository. No report was submitted.



Training example only. The screenshot illustrates the title, description and attachment area; it is not a claim of a verified PLOT defect.

1 **Write a specific title**
Name the affected tool/window and what went wrong. Avoid titles such as “Help” or “It does not work”.

2 **Describe what you did and what happened**
Include numbered steps, expected behavior, actual behavior, how often it occurs, code revision, OS and relevant units/tool/context. The next page provides a reusable outline.

3 **Prepare evidence before attaching**
Capture the relevant controls and any error message. Remove identifying worker/company data before uploading. Then attach your screenshot, preview the report and choose Create or Submit new issue.

Metadata such as assignee, milestone or project is normally managed by the team. You do not need to choose these to describe a problem.

Reference: GitHub issue creation

11 / REPORT A BUG

A reusable bug report outline

Copy these headings into the description. Replace each prompt with your actual observations.

Heading	What to write
Area and code revision	Affected window/tool, main branch, full commit ID from local Desktop History.
System	Windows/macOS version; x64/Intel/Apple silicon; interface language and display scaling if relevant.
Starting point	New or existing project; standalone or assigned assessment; relevant workplace/Job context. Use an anonymized name.
Steps to reproduce	Number the exact actions from a known starting point. Include entered values, units and Calculate/Apply actions when relevant.
Expected result	The behavior you reasonably expected.
Actual result	What you observed. Copy exact error text; describe data changes, disabled controls or incorrect display.
Frequency	Every attempt, intermittent, or one occurrence; whether closing/reopening changes it.
Evidence	A cropped screenshot; a small anonymized reproduction file only if needed; relevant error output as text.

For calculation or optimization problems

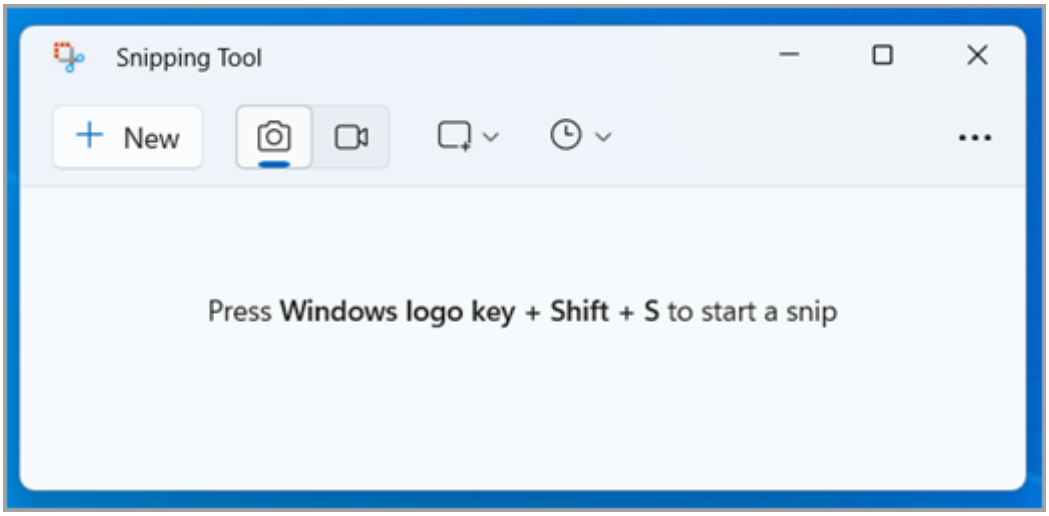
Include the selected method, task inputs, repetitions and units. Distinguish entered values from displayed rounding. For JROT, include scope, selected tools, block durations, worker restrictions and whether the result was a preview or kept.

Describe the symptom before guessing the cause
“Undo remains disabled after editing weight” is useful. “The database is broken” is a conclusion that may be wrong. If you cannot reproduce the problem again, still state exactly what you remember.

WINDOWS / EVIDENCE

Take a clear screenshot

Capture the area that explains the problem, including the relevant label or error.



Microsoft reference screenshot of Snipping Tool. Its layout can vary by Windows version.

1. **Reproduce the visible problem**
   Keep the necessary dialog or result visible.

2. **Press Windows + Shift + S**
   Choose a rectangular snip and drag around the relevant area.

3. **Save a PNG file**
   Open the capture notification or Snipping Tool editor, then use Save. Choose an easy-to-find folder and a descriptive filename.

4. **Inspect and redact before uploading**
   Crop unrelated material and remove sensitive information. Save the sanitized image as a separate file and reopen it to check.

Keep useful context
Include tool name, units and enough surrounding controls to identify the state. Avoid photographing the monitor when a screenshot is possible. Add exact error text to the report as well.

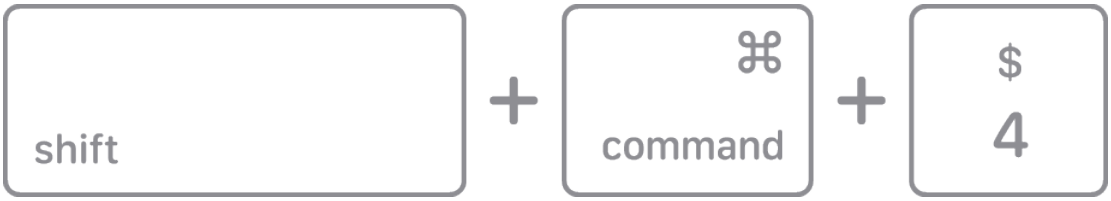
Example filename: **plot-label-after-resize.png**. A “before” and “after” pair can explain a layout or Undo problem better than one oversized full-desktop image.

Reference: Microsoft Snipping Tool

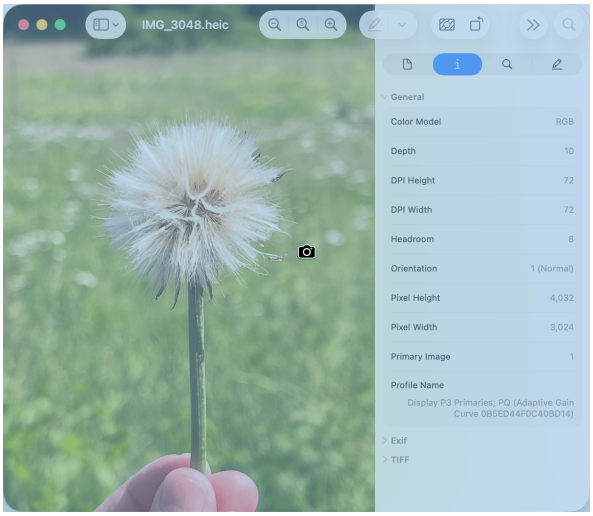
MACOS / EVIDENCE

Capture a window or selected area

The built-in Screenshot controls can save PNG evidence for your bug report.



Apple keyboard diagram: Shift + Command + 4 captures a selected area.



Apple reference screenshot showing window capture. This is a macOS example, not an ErgoTools acceptance capture.

1 **Capture a selected region**
Press **Shift + Command + 4**, then drag around the relevant area.

2 **Or capture a complete window**
Press **Shift + Command + 4**, release, press Space, then click the window.

3 **Find and inspect the file**
Screenshots normally save to Desktop. Shift + Command + 5 opens Options, where the location and capture settings can be changed. Use PNG/Most Compatible when available.

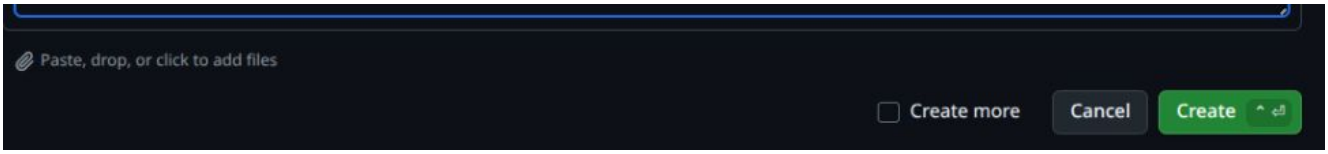
Check the saved image
Remove sensitive names or unrelated information before attaching. Keep labels and units readable. For textual errors, include the error as text in the issue too.

Reference: Apple screenshot instructions

12 / REPORT A BUG

Attach evidence and follow the reply

Review your files before selecting them in GitHub. Attachments upload as soon as you add them.



Actual ErgoTools issue editor: the attachment action sits below the description; Create posts the report. This capture did not submit anything.

1. **Use sanitized files**
   PNG/JPG screenshots work well. If the team needs an .ergprj reproduction file, use a small anonymized copy and ZIP it if GitHub does not accept that extension.

2. **Add the attachment**
   Drag it into the issue description, paste a screenshot (Ctrl + V on Windows; Command + V on Mac), or choose the attachment action to browse. Wait until upload processing finishes.

3. **Preview and submit**
   Confirm that images are visible, the steps are understandable and no confidential information is exposed. Then choose Create or Submit new issue. Save the resulting issue URL/number.

4. **Continue in the same thread**
   Return to your issue or follow GitHub's notifications. If the team asks for a test, update your clone, record the new commit ID and reply with the result. Add follow-up evidence in a comment.

Public means public
This repository is public. Do not upload identifiable worker demographics, health information, company-sensitive layouts or credentials. If you cannot safely anonymize the case, ask the maintainer for an approved private route before sending it.

To ZIP a sanitized project: Windows: right-click it and choose Compress to ZIP file (or Send to > Compressed folder). Mac: Control-click it and choose Compress. Zipping does not anonymize the contents.

If sensitive material is uploaded accidentally, contact the maintainer. Removing its text link does not prove that the upload is inaccessible.

Reference: GitHub attachment behavior and supported files

13 / STARTUP PROBLEMS

When ErgoTools will not open

Run the launcher in an already open terminal if the window closes before you can read the error.

Symptom	First useful check
Environment not found	The shortcut may target the wrong clone, or setup did not finish. Locate the original launcher in tools and follow the platform setup.
Missing PyQt5, vtk, highspy or openpyxl	Complete both environment-refresh commands on page 14 in the correct folder. Do not upgrade packages at random.
uv not recognized / command not found	Close and reopen PowerShell/Terminal after installing uv. Confirm its installation completed.
Wrong folder or missing requirements file	Check that the command prompt is in the repository containing README.md and tools, not in tools itself.
macOS permission or security alert	Use the trusted launcher and normal per-item approval where appropriate. Do not override a malware finding or organization policy.
Avatar missing, graphics error or solver failure	Record the full message, OS/chip, code revision and affected action. Native graphics and solver testing is still pending for these platforms.

Keep the error visible

Windows: from the repository in PowerShell, run **.\tools\run_windows.cmd**. Mac: from the repository in Terminal, run **./tools/run_macos.command**. Copy the error text into the bug report and include a screenshot if useful.

Do not install an unrelated older environment
Use this repository's current installation instructions. Older branch instructions and old Conda environments may use incompatible Python/Qt versions.

Reference: Current installation and launch instructions

14 / DISPLAY AND STARTUP REPORTS

Collect a useful diagnostic report

If a window is clipped, tiny, oversized or fails to open, keep the screenshot and the startup report together.

1. **Check the report location**
   Windows and macOS normally record startup/display information automatically. In ErgoTools, open Edit > Settings > General and find Display diagnostics. Use its report/folder controls to locate the current JSON file.

2. **If needed, launch with an explicit report folder**
   Close ErgoTools. Open the terminal in your repository, then run the command for your platform. This changes where the local report is written; it does not change display scaling or project data.

Windows PowerShell

```
.\tools\run_windows.cmd --startup-diagnostics --diagnostics-dir "$HOME\ErgoTools-test-evidence"
```

macOS Terminal

```
./tools/run_macos.command --startup-diagnostics --diagnostics-dir "$HOME/ErgoTools-test-evidence"
```

3. **Keep the report and describe the screen**
   Copy the newest JSON report from that folder. Record the OS version, display resolution, scaling percentage and which monitor contained ErgoTools. If startup stopped, include the terminal error as text.

4. **Use the capture checklist during the platform trial**
   The separate capture checklist lists the Windows/macOS windows to capture, suggested PNG filenames, expected outcomes and a test record. Return the images and report together so they can replace reference illustrations in this guide.

What the report can establish
It records startup and display observations. A report existing is not proof that all application features work; keep the successful and failed test outcomes alongside it.

Reference: Current installation and launch options

QUICK REFERENCE

Your regular routine

After the first successful setup, most work needs only these steps.

To open ErgoTools

Double-click the Windows shortcut or Mac alias. It launches the code already installed in its target folder; it does not contact GitHub for updates.

To get an update

1	2	3	4
Save and close ErgoTools	Desktop: ErgoTools + main; check Changes	Fetch origin; Pull origin if offered	Refresh libraries if needed; launch again

To report a problem

Record the local commit ID. Reproduce the problem on an anonymized example if possible. Search Issues, describe exact steps and expected/actual behavior, then add a sanitized screenshot.

Useful destinations

ErgoTools repository
Report and search issues
Current installation instructions
Download GitHub Desktop

Successful first setup checklist

Windows shortcut or Mac alias opens the intended clone.
The avatar appears; a personal test project opens.
LiFFT/DUET/ST and PLOT can be reviewed.
Selected-tool and all-tool JROT runs can be tried with test data.
A personal project can be saved, closed and reopened.

During the platform trial
Report any failed check. This list describes what to verify on Windows/macOS; it does not certify that those native tests have passed.

SOURCES AND IMAGE CREDITS

References and image credits

Links are clickable. Web references were reviewed for this edition; screens and labels may change.

ErgoTools
Repository and current installation recipe
Updated for the main-branch publication of 5 November 2026. Record your installed commit using Desktop History (page 15); this edition date is not a commit ID. Website images show the real repository and an unsubmitted training issue from the earlier edition.

GitHub and GitHub Desktop
Download Desktop | Install Desktop | Supported systems
Clone a repository | Fetch and pull | View history
Create an issue | Search issues | Attach files

Windows
Microsoft desktop shortcuts
Microsoft Snipping Tool

macOS
Apple aliases | Apple screenshots
Apple safe app opening
Finder Make Alias reference image - Schreiner University

Setup tool
Astral uv installation

Image provenance

GitHub Desktop menus, clone dialog, Fetch/Pull bars and History are reference images from GitHub Docs. Windows shortcut and Snipping Tool images are from Microsoft Support. Mac screenshot illustrations are from Apple Support. The Finder context menu is a Schreiner University support image from 2021; it demonstrates the alias concept using a different item.

Reference images retain their original interface content and sample names. ErgoTools-specific website screenshots were captured for this guide; crops and numbered annotations improve readability. No native Windows/macOS ErgoTools screenshots or successful installations are implied by those reference images.

ErgoTools logo: project asset. Screenshots and product marks belong to their respective owners and are included for instructional context. No issue was posted, no sample file was uploaded, and no repository setting was changed to produce this guide.